

039. Chapter 3 Verses 35-37

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.35

श्रेयान्स्वधर्मो विगुणः परधर्मात्स्वनुष्ठितात् ।
स्वधर्मे निधनं श्रेयः परधर्मो भयावहः ॥ 35 ॥

śreyānsvadharma viguṇaḥ
paradharmātsvanuṣṭhitāt |
svadharṁe nidhanaṁ śreyaḥ
paradharmo bhayāvahaḥ ||

- ◆ **śreyān** – better; **sva-dharmaḥ** – one's own duty; **viguṇaḥ** – though devoid of merit;
- ◆ **paradharmāt** – than the duty of another; **su-anuṣṭhitāt** – well-performed;
- ◆ **svadharṁe** – in one's own duty; **nidhanam** – death; **śreyaḥ** – better;
- ◆ **para-dharmaḥ** – another's duty; **bhaya-āvahaḥ** – fraught with fear.

One's own duty, ill-performed and without merit, is better than the duty of another well-discharged. Better is death in discharging one's own duty. Another's duty is fraught with fear.

VERSE 3.36

अर्जुन उवाच ।

अथ केन प्रयुक्तोऽयं पापं चरति पूरुषः ।

अनिच्छन्नपि वार्ष्णेय बलादिव नियोजितः ॥ 36 ॥

arjuna uvāca |

atha kena prayukto'yaṁ

pāpaṁ carati pūruṣaḥ |

anicchannapi vārṣṇeya

balādiva niyojitaḥ ||

◆ **arjunaḥ uvāca** – Arjuna said;

◆ **atha** – then; **kena** – by what; **prayuktaḥ** – impelled; **ayaṁ** – this;

◆ **pāpaṁ** – sin; **carati** – commits; **pūruṣaḥ** – man;

◆ **anicchan** – not wishing; **api** – even; **vārṣṇeya** – O Varshneya (Krishna);

◆ **balāt** – by force; **iva** – as if; **niyojitaḥ** – constrained.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! Constrained by force as it were, by what does man commit sin even against his wish?

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।

काम एष क्रोध एष रजोगुणसमुद्भवः ॥

महाशनो महापाप्मा विद्ध्येनमिह वैरिणम् ॥ 37 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |

kāma eṣa krodha eṣa

rajoguṇasamudbhavaḥ |

mahāśano mahāpāpmā

viddhyenamiha vairiṇam ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said;

◆ kāmaḥ – desire; eṣaḥ – this; krodhaḥ – anger; eṣaḥ – this;

◆ rajo-guṇa – the mode of passion; samudbhavaḥ – born of;

◆ mahā-aśanaḥ – all-devouring; mahā-pāpmā – all-sinful;

◆ viddhi – know; enam – this; iha – here; vairiṇam – the enemy.

**The Blessed Lord said: It is desire, it is anger, born of
Rajoguna (the impulse of action), all-consuming and all-evil.
Know this as the enemy here.**